Kitchen *& Kettle*

Food Preservation Logbook

TRACK WHAT YOU PRESERVE. REMEMBER WHAT WORKED.

Canning logs, fermentation trackers, dehydrating notes, and a seasonal produce guide — everything you need to keep track of a year of preserving, in one place.

No food is truly preserved if you forget where you put it.

How to use this logbook

The point of preserving food is to eat it later. This logbook makes sure "later" actually happens — and that you remember what worked so you can do it again.

WHAT'S INSIDE

1. **Canning log** — Record every batch. Recipe, date, yield, processing method, and how it turned out when you opened it.
2. **Fermentation tracker** — Start date, ingredients, salt ratio, tasting notes. Ferments change over time — track the journey.
3. **Dehydrating notes** — What you dried, how you prepped it, temperature, time, and whether the result was worth repeating.
4. **Seasonal produce guide** — What's in season when, and what to do with it. Reference pages, not blank templates.

WHEN TO USE EACH SECTION

- **During preserving season** (summer/fall): Fill out logs as you go. Don't wait — you'll forget details.
- **When you open a jar** (all year): Go back and add notes. Was the texture good? Too salty? Perfect? This is the most valuable data.
- **Before next year's season**: Review last year's logs. Double the pickles, skip the pear butter, try that new hot sauce recipe.

> *The notes column is the most important field on every page. "Tasted flat — add more vinegar next time" is worth more than any recipe. Write down what actually happened.*

A NOTE ON SAFETY

This logbook assumes you already know safe canning and fermentation practices. If you're new to preserving, consult tested recipes and safety guidelines (USDA, NCHFP, or a reputable modern preserving book) before filling these pages.

> *The processing time and method fields exist because they matter for safety. Don't skip them. Botulism is rare but real — follow tested recipes.*

Canning Log

Year: _____

> *Fill this out the same day you process. Memory is unreliable — especially during a marathon canning session.*

DATE	RECIPE / CONTENTS	JARS / SIZE	METHOD	TIME	YIELD	RESULT / NOTES
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____

WB = water bath PC = pressure canner Record processing time per tested recipe.

Canning Log (continued)

Year: _____

DATE	RECIPE / CONTENTS	JARS / SIZE	METHOD	TIME	YIELD	RESULT / NOTES
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____
____	_____	____	WB / PC	____	____	_____

YEAR-END REVIEW

Total jars processed this year: ____

Best batch (make again for sure): _____

Worst batch (skip next year): _____

What to do differently next year: _____

Fermentation Tracker

Year: _____

> *Ferments are alive — they change. Taste every few days and write notes. The day something tastes perfect is the day it goes in the fridge.*

STARTED	RECIPE / WHAT'S IN IT	SALT RATIO / BRINE %

TASTING NOTES

Day __ (____): _____

Day __ (____): _____

Day __ (____): _____

Day __ (____): _____

Ready on: _____ Stored: fridge / cellar / other

STARTED	RECIPE / WHAT'S IN IT	SALT RATIO / BRINE %

TASTING NOTES

Day __ (____): _____

Day __ (____): _____

Day __ (____): _____

Day __ (____): _____

Ready on: _____ Stored: fridge / cellar / other

STARTED	RECIPE / WHAT'S IN IT	SALT RATIO / BRINE %

TASTING NOTES

Day __ (____): _____

Day __ (____): _____

Day __ (____): _____

Day __ (____): _____

Ready on: _____ Stored: fridge / cellar / other

STARTED	RECIPE / WHAT'S IN IT	SALT RATIO / BRINE %

TASTING NOTES

Day __ (____): _____

Day __ (____): _____

Day __ (____): _____

Day __ (____): _____

Ready on: _____ Stored: fridge / cellar / other

Dehydrating Notes

> *Write down what you dried, how you prepped it, and whether it was worth the effort. Some things dehydrate beautifully (tomatoes, herbs, mushrooms). Some don't (cucumbers — don't bother).*

DATE	FOOD	PREP METHOD	TEMP	TIME	RESULT / WORTH IT?
____	_____	_____	___°	___h	_____
____	_____	_____	___°	___h	_____
____	_____	_____	___°	___h	_____
____	_____	_____	___°	___h	_____
____	_____	_____	___°	___h	_____
____	_____	_____	___°	___h	_____
____	_____	_____	___°	___h	_____

Seasonal Produce at a Glance

Northern hemisphere, temperate climate. Adjust for your region. **Key:** F = freeze C = can D = dehydrate L = lacto-ferment R = root cellar

SPRING

Asparagus	*F C*
Peas	*F*
Rhubarb	*F C*
Greens (spinach, chard)	*F D*
Radishes	*L*
Herbs (tender)	*D F*
Strawberries	*F C D*

SUMMER

Tomatoes	*C F D*
Cucumbers	*L C*
Zucchini / squash	*F D*
Peppers	*F D C*
Green beans	*C F L*
Corn	*F C*
Berries (all kinds)	*F C D*
Stone fruit	*C F D*

AUTUMN

Apples / pears	*C D R*
Winter squash	*R*
Pumpkin	*F C R*
Root vegetables	*R L*
Cabbage	*L R*
Brussels sprouts	*F R*
Cranberries	*F C D*
Mushrooms (wild)	*D F*

WINTER

Citrus	*D (peel) C (marmalade)*
Root veg (stored)	*use from cellar*
Apples / pears (stored)	*use from cellar*
Winter squash (stored)	*use from cellar*
Preserved goods	*eat what you put up*

A note on preserving

Preserving food isn't about stockpiling for the apocalypse. It's about capturing a moment of abundance — the week tomatoes are perfect, the month apples are falling off the tree — and spreading that abundance across the rest of the year.

Your grandmother's generation did this because they had to. You're doing it because you want to. That's a privilege. Enjoy it.

Some years you'll put up fifty jars of peaches and feel like a genius. Other years you'll preserve exactly nothing and eat takeout all August. Both years are fine. The logbook is here when you want it — not as an obligation.

FAVORITE RECIPES TO REPEAT

NEW THINGS TO TRY NEXT YEAR

EQUIPMENT TO ACQUIRE / REPLACE

GOOD SOURCES FOR PRODUCE